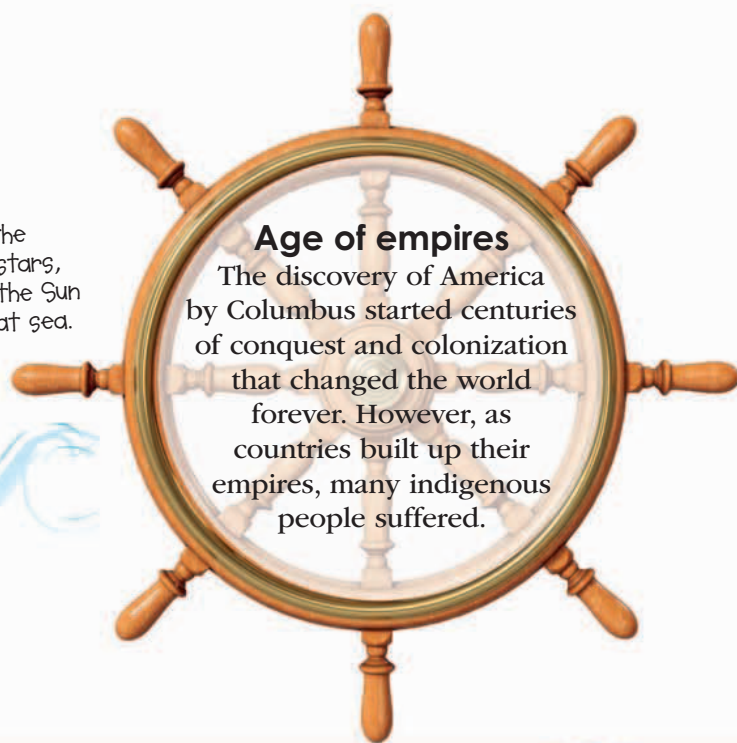




## Accidental hero

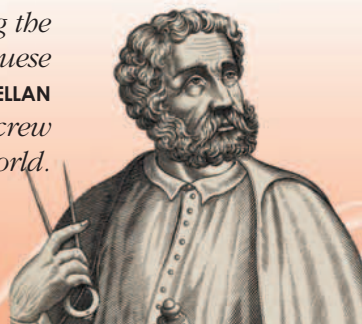
After being turned down in Portugal, Columbus got the funding he needed from Spain and, in 1492, he set sail across the **Atlantic Ocean**. Ten weeks later, his ships spotted land and Columbus went ashore on what he thought was an island near India, calling the indigenous people “Indians”—he was actually in the Caribbean. Of course, Columbus hadn’t found a **shortcut to India**, but he did discover the land we would come to know as **AMERICA**.

Columbus used the position of the stars, the Moon, and the Sun to find his way at sea.



He paved the way for...

Although he died along the way, in 1519, the Portuguese explorer **FERDINAND MAGELLAN** (1480–1521) led the first crew ever to sail around the world.



Another Portuguese explorer, **VASCO DA GAMA** (c.1460–1524), was the first to sail directly from Europe to India.

